

this research examines the adaptation problems experienced in boarding schools based on the experiences of school psychological counselors, a phenomenological design has been chosen. Qualitative research focuses on describing events and phenomena in their natural environments, understanding, and reflecting the perspectives of the participants, with an inductive approach. Unlike quantitative research, which is based on the positivist paradigm, qualitative research is far from making generalizations (Putnam, 1983). In this study, qualitative paradigm was employed since we aimed to investigate the adaptation problems of RBS students with their unique dimensions and to make in-depth discoveries from the perspective of school psychological counselors. In qualitative research, data can be collected through focus group interviews. Focus group interviews, which are frequently used in educational research, are one of the systemic data collection methods (Kitzinger, 1995). The aim of the focus group interviews is to obtain in-depth, detailed, and multidimensional qualitative data about the perspectives, experiences, thoughts, perceptions, and attitudes of the participants about a certain topic (Bowling, 2002). A rich flow of information is provided as a result of in-group interaction. Moreover, the aim of the focus group interviews is to reveal how the participants perceive the subject being studied rather than making explanations about the participants. Despite all its positive aspects, it is often difficult to predict what will come out of the focus group interviews due to its open-ended nature. For this reason, it is recommended to discuss a limited number of concepts or topics (Edmunds, 2000). In this context, eight psychological counselors working in the regional boarding schools were reached by using purposeful sampling in determining the focus group. Purposeful sampling can be used to gather rich data from experiences in qualitative research (Patton, 2014). The inclusion criteria for the study were determined as being employed in boarding schools in rural areas and having a degree in psychological counseling and guidance.

Participants

All participants are psychological counselors working at RBSs located in different regions of Türkiye. There is a total of 8 participants (3 females, 5 males). Three participants from the Mediterranean Region (Kahramanmaraş/ $n=1$ and Adana/ $n=2$), three participants from the Central Anatolia Region (Aksaray/ $n=1$, Eskişehir/ $n=1$, and Sivas/ $n=1$), one participant from the Marmara Region (Istanbul/ $n=1$), and one participant from the Eastern Anatolia Region (Erzurum/ $n=1$) voluntarily decided to participate in the study. Participants are aged between 26-33 and have worked at RBSs between 5-10 years. Participants agreed to take part in the study voluntarily and each participant signed a "participant consent form" beforehand. Each participant was assigned a pseudonym and these pseudonyms were used in the findings section of the research.

Collecting Data

After having obtained the Ethics Committee Approval for the research, a face-to-face meeting was held at the Psychological Counseling Unit in İnönü University with the volunteer participants to collect data through the focus group interview. The opinions of school psychological counselors were asked by employing questions such as "What do you think the source of your students' adaptation problems is?", "How does the process of applying to the guidance service work for students who have adjustment problems?". The discussion, which lasted for 2 hours 46 minutes and 32 seconds, was audio recorded with the consent of the participants. The interview questions for the focus group discussion were prepared in the form of a semi-structured questionnaire. The interview questions were organized and finalized after obtaining input from two experts with doctoral degrees in the field of Guidance and Psychological Counseling. The semi-structured form was used in the study to ensure that the focus group discussion progresses along a specific axis while also allowing the researcher the necessary flexibility.

Analyzing Data

Thematic analysis procedures defined by Braun and Clarke (2006) were employed for data analysis. Accordingly, to become familiar with the data, transcripts were initially read from start to finish without any coding. In the second step, the data set was re-read and coded. This was done to ensure coder reliability. Coder reliability is achieved through the process of reconfiguration at different time intervals (Miles & Huberman, 2016). In the third step, five randomly selected data sets were provided to and analyzed by three faculty